Practice workbook · Ethics in research

Informed consent, deception, confidentiality, right to withdraw and protection of participants.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-04

1. Question 1 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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1 Gary conducted an experiment to test whether there was a difference in the ability of boys and girls to conserve number. He sampled 50 boys and 50 girls aged six years old.

Gary showed them the image in **Figure 1**.

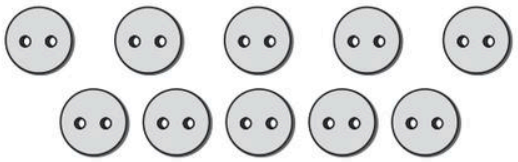


Figure 1

Gary asked each child to say whether the top row of buttons contained more, less, or the same number of buttons as the bottom row.

(a) Identify the independent variable in Gary's experiment.

(1)

- ☒ **A** age
- ☒ **B** gender
- ☒ **C** ability
- ☒ **D** conservation

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(b) Give **two** ways that Gary could ensure his experiment is ethical.

(2)

1 .....

.....

.....

2 .....

.....

.....

1. Question 1 · part b · 2 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

The results of Gary's experiment are shown in **Table 1**.

	Number of children who said the top row contained less buttons than the bottom row	Number of children who said the top row contained the same number of buttons as the bottom row	Number of children who said the top row contained more buttons than the bottom row
Boys	5	13	32
Girls	1	25	24

Table 1

(c) Calculate the percentage of girls who said that the top row contained the **same** number of buttons as the bottom row, out of all the children in the experiment.

(2)

Percentage .....

(d) Calculate the range for the number of children who said the top row contained **more** buttons than the bottom row.

(1)

Range .....

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1. Question 1 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 1 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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1 Matthew investigated the effectiveness of drug treatment for patients with depression. He interviewed six patients from a local mental health service provider before and after drug treatment.

Matthew only used preset questions in his interview.

(a) Identify the type of interview Matthew used in his investigation.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Structured interview
- ☒ **B** Unstructured interview
- ☒ **C** Semi-structured interview
- ☒ **D** Covert interview

(b) Matthew made sure that the participants in his interviews had the right to withdraw.

Define what is meant by the 'right to withdraw'.

(1)

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(c) Give **two** ways that Matthew could ensure the confidentiality of the patients he interviewed.

(2)

1 .....

.....

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2 .....

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.....

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2. Question 1 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 1 · part c · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

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1 Matthew investigated the effectiveness of drug treatment for patients with depression. He interviewed six patients from a local mental health service provider before and after drug treatment.

Matthew only used preset questions in his interview.

(a) Identify the type of interview Matthew used in his investigation.

(1)

☒ **A** Structured interview

☒ **B** Unstructured interview

☒ **C** Semi-structured interview

☒ **D** Covert interview

(b) Matthew made sure that the participants in his interviews had the right to withdraw.

Define what is meant by the 'right to withdraw'.

(1)

.....

.....

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(c) Give **two** ways that Matthew could ensure the confidentiality of the patients he interviewed.

(2)

1 .....

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2 .....

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3. Question 1 · part c · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(d) Participant responses to the question 'How often do you feel tired?' were scored using a scale of 0 to 5, with 0 being 'never feel tired' and 5 being 'always feel tired'.

The results of Matthew's investigation are shown in **Table 1**.

Participant	Score (out of 5) for tiredness before drug treatment	Score (out of 5) for tiredness after drug treatment
A	5	3
B	4	3
C	5	2
D	3	0
E	5	1
F	4	1

Table 1

(i) The score for tiredness of **Participant F** decreased from before drug treatment to after drug treatment.

Calculate the percentage decrease in the score for tiredness of **Participant F**.

(2)

Percentage decrease in score for tiredness of **Participant F** .....

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P 5 9 6 6 9 A 0 4 4 8

3. Question 1 · part c · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 1 · part b · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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1 James is investigating the impact of brain damage on memory. He asks a brain-damaged patient to come to the university where he has set up a room to conduct a test of word recall.

(a) Identify the research method James is using in his investigation.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Questionnaire
- ☒ **B** Laboratory experiment
- ☒ **C** Natural experiment
- ☒ **D** Interview

(b) Describe how James can maintain the confidentiality of the patient when he publishes his investigation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 1 = 3 marks)

Working and answer

5. Question 4 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

4 Jamie investigated whether personality influences obedience to an authority figure. He used a questionnaire with open-ended and closed-ended questions about personality traits and obedient behaviour.

(a) Describe **one** reason why Jamie may have used open-ended questions in his investigation.

(2)

(b) State **one** ethical issue that Jamie should have considered in his investigation.

(1)

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5. Question 4 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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Jamie found that eight of his participants scored highly for authoritarian personality.

The number of obedient acts they had reported for the previous week are shown in **Table 4**.

Participant	Number of reported obedient acts (in a week)
A	15
B	14
C	18
D	16
E	18
F	14
G	13
H	19

Table 4

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(c) Calculate the median score for the number of obedient acts reported by participants in **Table 4**.

(2)

Median .....

(d) Calculate the range for the number of obedient acts reported by the participants in **Table 4**.

(1)

Range .....

(Total for Question 4 = 6 marks)

5. Question 4 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 1 · part whole · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE

1 Identify the ethical issue that has been dealt with when a researcher tells participants the true aims of a study before they decide to take part.

- ☒ **A** Confidentiality
- ☒ **B** Informed consent
- ☒ **C** Right to withdraw
- ☒ **D** Protection of participants

(Total for Question 1 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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